

Part I dealt with Krishna's relationships with Radha and his wives Satyabhama, Rukmini and Jambavati. Parts II and III will focus on his strategy and draw from the Bhagavad Gita.

ones building a franchise around an Indian divinity. Raj Kurup of Creative-Land Studios, the makers of *Krishnavataram*, recently announced "a trans-media universe bringing the timeless stories, wisdom and spirit" of Krishna. The ambitious project, which has the backing of The Art of Living's World Forum for Arts & Culture, also plans to have merchandise, theme parks, musicals, video games and educational shows for kids, besides films. "This is not about religion or gods," Kurup said at a gathering for media, "these are stories for us. I want to make culture fun and accessible. Our rich heritage is not just for oldies, but for kids to understand too."

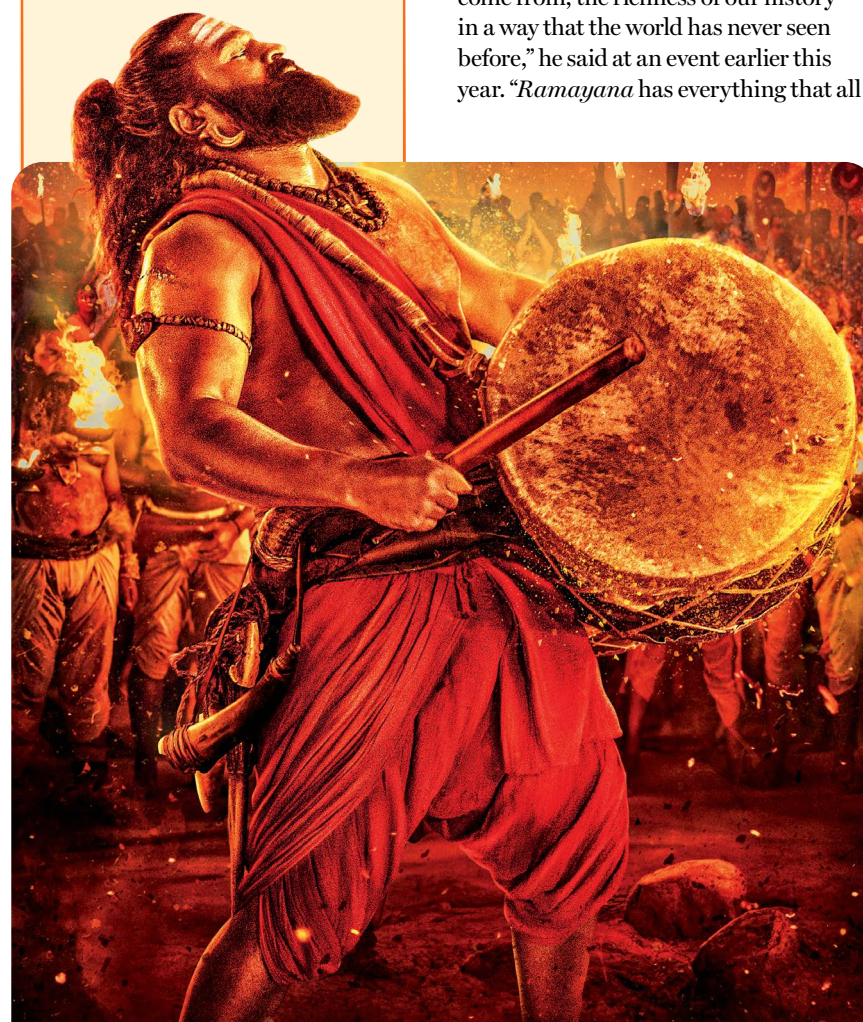
Kantara

Director: *Rishab Shetty*

Producers: *Vijay Kiragandur & Chaluve Gowda*

Dates of release: *Original and prequel out; sequel, TBA*

Shetty's films, about an underdog seeking justice, spotlight coastal Karnataka's deities and depict Bhooth Kol, a ritualistic performance by a local medium to summon guardian spirits.



Back to the Roots

The industry's growing faith in mythology as a bankable genre, alongside the flood of films based on the Hindu faith, reflect a broader push to reclaim Indian civilisation and recast its lore as a source of pride. In a conversation titled 'Ramayana Lives On' with Sadhguru, *Ramayana* producer Malhotra said he was "troubled" about the epic not being taught in schools. "We're learning British and Mughal history and what they did to us but not our history, the origin of where we come from," he said. The Ramayana films, he asserts, stem from his desire to make Indians proud of their cultural identity and erase the "victim mindset".

Also the CEO of DNEG Studios, the visual effects company that has won seven Oscars till date, Malhotra calls *Ramayana* a passion project with which he hopes to elevate Indian cinema to a global platform. "We got to bring something that shows who we are, where we come from, the richness of our history in a way that the world has never seen before," he said at an event earlier this year. "*Ramayana* has everything that all